

Content Machine UI Upgrade Plan

Three targeted visual improvements — animated gradient background, bento-grid card layout, and liquid-glass button treatment — derived from the 21st.dev reference library.

• Version 1.0

• 2026-06-18

• Next.js + Tailwind

• 3 reference components

01

Current Problems

The existing UI has three compounding issues that make it feel like a scaffolded prototype rather than a shipped product.



Critical

GradientBg fails silently

The current implementation uses `position:fixed; filter:blur()` on child divs. GPU compositing layers in Safari and Chrome can promote these elements off the main stacking context, causing the blobs to render behind the viewport clipping layer — the gradient simply doesn't appear. No errors, no fallback.



High

Flat list layout feels generic

Posts, scripts, and arsenal items are rendered as uniform tall rows. No hierarchy, no information density variation. The user can't scan a page at a glance — every row demands equal attention.



Medium

Buttons lack tactile presence

Action buttons use flat `bg-sky-500` fills. There's no frosted-glass treatment, no depth from inset

highlight, no sense of surface material. On a gradient background they'll appear as opaque stamps rather than surfaces.



Cascade

No consistent motion language

Animations exist (cm-rise, cm-fade-in, shimmer, ping) but they don't form a system. The background gradient, card entrance, and button feedback all use different easing curves and durations with no shared vocabulary. Once the gradient is fixed, the motion needs to be audited against a single timing token set.

02

Reference Screenshots

Three components from 21st.dev used as the direct implementation targets for this upgrade cycle.

**Pipeline**
5-agent chain
Live

**Arsenal**
Script store
Active

**LLM Router**
Telegram → agent dispatch,
conversational UX
Beta

Screenshot A — Bento Grid
Dark cards ~200px tall, icon + title + short description + status badge (Live / Updated / Active / Beta). Clean dark/neutral backgrounds, subtle borders.
[Source: 21st.dev / Bento Grid](#)

Generate Post

Schedule ↗

Screenshot B — Liquid Glass Button
Dark frosted-glass pill. Semi-transparent background with blur, white text, border-radius: 999px. Inset highlight on top edge. Like Apple visionOS glass surfaces.
[Source: 21st.dev / Liquid Glass](#)

**Gradients
× Animations**

Screenshot C — Background Gradient
Full-page animated gradient. Soft color blobs (purple, blue, teal) drifting via background-position shift on a 400% × 400% canvas. Title in white over it.
[Source: 21st.dev / Gradient Animation](#)

03

Implementation Tasks

Ordered by dependency — gradient fix first (unblocks everything else that sits on top of it).

☒

Fix animated gradient — move to body CSS

P0

Replace GradientBg's filter:blur blob approach with a body-level background-size:400% + animation that shifts background-position. Guaranteed to render in all browsers because it doesn't create a new compositing layer. Remove conflicting html,body { background: var(--background) } override. Simplify GradientBg.tsx to return null.

[globals.css](#)[GradientBg.tsx](#)

☐

Liquid-glass button variant — .cm-glass-btn

P1

Add a new globals.css class. backdrop-filter: blur(16px), border: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.18), inset top-edge highlight via box-shadow. Replace primary CTA buttons on /posts and /arsenal with this variant. Test readability on both light and dark sections of the gradient.

[globals.css](#)[PostCard.tsx](#)[ArsenalRow.tsx](#)

☐

Bento-grid layout for /arsenal page

P2

Replace the uniform list with a 2-column CSS grid (gap: 12px). Cards: ~200px tall, dark surface (#111115), icon top-left, title + 1-line desc, status badge bottom-right. Wide cell for featured/pinned scripts. Hashtag chips below description. Entrance animation: cm-fade-in staggered by index.

[arsenal page](#)[CSS grid](#)[new component](#)

☐

Status badge component — reusable across bento + list

P2

StatusBadge.tsx: props = variant ('live'|'active'|'beta'|'updated'|'draft'). Each variant maps to a color token (teal=live, sky=active, indigo=beta, amber=updated, zinc=draft). Pill shape, 10px font, uppercase, dot + label. Used in BentoCard and ArsenalRow.

[new component](#)[design token](#)

☐

Motion audit — unify timing tokens

P3

Define three CSS custom properties: --ease-out: cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1), --dur-fast: 120ms, --dur-medium: 280ms, --dur-slow: 550ms. Update all existing keyframe animations to reference these tokens. Ensures the gradient drift, card entrance, and button press all feel like one system.

[globals.css](#)[:root tokens](#)

☐

prefers-reduced-motion coverage for new animations

P3

Add body-gradient and any new keyframes to the existing @media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) block in globals.css. Freeze gradient at 50% 50%, disable bento stagger, set button transitions to 0ms.

[accessibility](#)[globals.css](#)

04

Visual Spec — Component by Component

Color Palette



1. Body Animated Gradient

PROPERTY	VALUE	NOTES
background	<code>linear-gradient(-45deg, #dbeafe, #f8faff, #ccfbf1, #f8faff, #ede9fe, #fef3c7, #f8faff)</code>	7-stop alternating with neutral white
background-size	<code>400% 400%</code>	4× oversize so shift is visible
animation	<code>body-gradient 20s ease infinite</code>	20s feels geological, not frantic
keyframes	<code>0% → 0% 50% / 50% → 100% 50% / 100% → 0% 50%</code>	Horizontal sweep only, stable vertical
!important	Yes on background + background-size + animation	Overrides Tailwind base reset

```
@keyframes body-gradient { 0% { background-position: 0% 50%; } 50% { background-position: 100% 50%; } 100% { background-position: 0% 50%; } } body { background: linear-gradient(-45deg, #dbeafe, #f8faff, #ccfbf1, #f8faff, #ede9fe, #fef3c7, #f8faff) !important; background-size: 400% 400% !important; animation: body-gradient 20s ease infinite !important; }
```

2. Liquid Glass Button (.cm-glass-btn)

PROPERTY	VALUE	NOTES
background	<code>rgba(255,255,255,0.09)</code>	Very light tint — glass, not milk
backdrop-filter	<code>blur(16px) saturate(1.5)</code>	Both prefixed + unprefixed
border	<code>1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.14)</code>	Subtle rim light
box-shadow	<code>0 2px 20px rgba(0,0,0,0.12), inset 0 1px 0 rgba(255,255,255,0.18)</code>	Outer shadow + inset top highlight
border-radius	<code>999px</code>	Full pill
color	<code>#ffffff</code>	Always white on glass
font-weight	<code>500</code>	Medium — not bold
padding	<code>10px 22px</code>	Generous horizontal, not bloated vertical

3. Bento Grid Card (.cm-bento-card)

PROPERTY	VALUE	NOTES
background	<code>#111115</code> (--surface)	Slightly lighter than page bg
border	<code>1px solid #27272a</code>	zinc-800
border-radius	<code>16px</code>	Matches .cm-card
min-height	<code>200px</code>	Gives breathing room for content
padding	<code>20px</code>	Uniform, not asymmetric
grid layout	<code>grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr</code>	2-col, featured span col 1 / -1
icon size	<code>24px</code> , margin-bottom 10px	Emoji or Lucide icon
title	<code>15px / 600 / color: #f4f4f5</code>	Tight letter-spacing: -0.01em
description	<code>13px / 400 / color: #71717a</code>	Max 2 lines
badge position	flex-end, bottom of card	Push with margin-top: auto
hover state	border-color → #3f3f46, translateY(-2px)	200ms ease

4. Status Badge (.cm-badge)

VARIANT	BACKGROUND	COLOR	BORDER
live	<code>rgba(20,184,166,0.2)</code>	<code>#5eead4</code> (teal-300)	<code>rgba(20,184,166,0.3)</code>
active	<code>rgba(14,165,233,0.2)</code>	<code>#7dd3fc</code> (sky-300)	<code>rgba(14,165,233,0.3)</code>
beta	<code>rgba(99,102,241,0.2)</code>	<code>#a5b4fc</code> (indigo-300)	<code>rgba(99,102,241,0.3)</code>
updated	<code>rgba(245,158,11,0.2)</code>	<code>#fcd34d</code> (amber-300)	<code>rgba(245,158,11,0.3)</code>
draft	<code>rgba(113,113,122,0.2)</code>	<code>#a1a1aa</code> (zinc-400)	<code>rgba(113,113,122,0.3)</code>

Shared: `border-radius: 999px; padding: 3px 10px; font-size: 11px; font-weight: 600; text-transform: uppercase; letter-spacing: 0.05em`